

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 320

By Reeves

A RESOLUTION to honor and recognize Reverend Kenneth Hill
on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that the members of this General Assembly should honor those individuals who have answered a divine call to the ministry and have served with dedication, vigor, and enthusiasm to perform God's work for their congregations and communities; and

WHEREAS, one such individual is Reverend Kenneth Hill, pastor of the historic Shorter Chapel African Methodist Episcopal (AME) Church, who has recently taken his much-deserved retirement; and

WHEREAS, a devout leader of Christ, Reverend Hill has been an influential leader in religious ministry for forty-three years and has served the Shorter Chapel AME Church as pastor for ten years; and

WHEREAS, Reverend Hill was born in Martinsville, Virginia; his father, a World War II veteran, moved his family to Detroit, Michigan, for greater economic opportunities; and

WHEREAS, Reverend Kenneth Hill attended Wayne State University and studied education, where he was introduced and drawn to social activism, although he knew his heart truly belonged to ministry and the Wesleyan theology; and

WHEREAS, Reverend Hill went on to earn his Master of Theology degree from Harvard Divinity School and joined Harambee, in which he was a leader; and

WHEREAS, he earned his Doctor of Philosophy degree from the University of Michigan and returned to Detroit, where he became a part of the Ebenezer AME Church and received mentorship that would launch his career in ministry; and

WHEREAS, Reverend Hill's ideas in teaching and preaching led to his being named the Fourth Executive Director of Christian Education in the 13th Episcopal District AME Church in Nashville, where he supervised twenty-seven congregations throughout the district, and Presiding Elder of the East Tennessee and West Kentucky Annual Conferences of the 13th Episcopal District; and

WHEREAS, in these leadership positions, Reverend Kenneth Hill established and introduced several new ministries, while also making improvements to the AME Church's school literature, developing a comprehensive guide for teachers, and overall, bringing significant change to the church; and

WHEREAS, following thirty-three years of astute service as a traveling preacher for the 13th Episcopal District AME Church and simultaneously raising his family, Reverend Hill desired to settle down and requested his own church; and

WHEREAS, in December 2014, Reverend Kenneth Hill was appointed to Shorter Chapel AME Church in Franklin, and with him at the helm, the congregation grew in their relationship with Christ through joy, fellowship, and unity, providing each attending member an enthusiastic church family and community; and

WHEREAS, a profound leader in his community, Reverend Hill has remained a trailblazer in preserving the history of Franklin and Williamson County, all the while engaging the community in the process; and

WHEREAS, in 2018, Reverend Hill, alongside Franklin Mayor Ken Moore, founded Unite Williamson, a nonprofit organization that engages leaders of diverse faith backgrounds to foster unity and celebrate the community of Williamson County; and

WHEREAS, during his estimable career, Reverend Kenneth Hill has authored numerous books and taught at several universities and seminaries throughout the Midwest and the South; and

WHEREAS, his many professional accomplishments aside, Reverend Hill is most grateful for the love and support of his beloved wife, Dr. Roberta Hill, and their cherished family; and

WHEREAS, Reverend Hill has continued to demonstrate excellence in his calling as a man of God; the members of his congregation were proud to call him their pastor, leader, and friend; and

WHEREAS, a true shepherd of the flock, Reverend Kenneth Hill has an abiding love for the ministry; his many contributions to his church, his community, and this State are deeply appreciated, and it is wholly fitting that he be recognized on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Reverend Kenneth Hill on the occasion of his retirement, thank him for his meritorious service as pastor of the Shorter Chapel African Methodist Episcopal Church, and extend to him our best wishes for every future success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.